DAY 33 | PRE-READ

Keeping AI Running Day After Day

A light read before Day 33. About 15 minutes, no code required.

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Why read this?

Building an AI feature is the exciting part. Keeping it working every day, for thousands of users, is where most of the real work happens. Tomorrow is about running AI in production. It is also an assessment day.

1. A car needs servicing

Buying a car is not the end; it needs fuel, servicing and repairs. AI applications are similar. The model provider updates models, users ask new kinds of questions, costs change. Running AI reliably is called **LLMOps**.

2. How AI apps break

Problem	Everyday comparison
Too many requests at once (rate limits)	A shop that only lets 50 people in at a time
The AI provider is slow or down	A supplier who does not deliver on time
The model changes or is retired	A favourite restaurant changes its chef, or closes
Costs suddenly jump	A phone bill that doubles because an app kept running

Good systems expect these problems: they try again sensibly, switch to a backup, and tell users clearly when something is wrong.

3. Knowing exactly what you shipped NEW (v4)

A pharmacy records the batch number of every medicine. AI teams do the same: they record the exact prompt, tools, skills, connected services and model behind every release. For agents this is called **AgentOps**.

4. Every word has a price

AI services charge by the token. Teams cut cost by keeping prompts lean, reusing answers to repeated questions, and sending easy questions to smaller, cheaper models. You practised this on Day 25.

Key idea: you cannot manage what you do not measure. Log versions, tokens and latency for every request.

5. About tomorrow's assessment

Day 33 includes GenAI assessment 3 (1.5 hours): security and guardrails (Day 30), evaluation (Days 31 and 32) and LLMOps. Review those post-reads tonight.

6. Think about these before class

- Recall a time a service you rely on failed. How did the company handle it?
- What would you need to record to explain an AI answer given six months ago?
- If your favourite AI model were retired next month, what would you need to check before switching?

Kiroku (記録): a record, keeping records